

Word family: **grade / grades / graded / grading / grader / gradation / gradual / gradually**

Base word: grade

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

* **grade** (n.) — 成績；年級；等級；級別；坡度

* **grade** (v.) — 評分；分級；按等級分類

* **graded** (adj./participle) — 已評分的；分級的

* **grading** (n.) — 評分；分級制度

* **grader** (n.) — 評分者；平地機；某年級學生 (AmE compounds)

* **gradation** (n.) — 漸變；層次變化

* **gradual** (adj.) — 逐漸的

* **gradually** (adv.) — 逐漸地

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **get a good grade**

* **final grade**

* **grade point**

* **grade point average / GPA**

* **grade an exam**

* **grade papers**

* **grading system**

* **first grade / fifth grade**

* **grade level**

* **high-grade / low-grade**

* **food grade**

* **medical grade**

* **industrial grade**

* **grade A**

* **on a steep grade**

* **upgrade / downgrade** *(lexical extensions with their own broader uses)*

Meaning in this passage

> My group and I were in the library preparing for an important presentation that counted for a large part of our **grade**.

Here, **grade** means:

the overall academic mark or result a student receives for a course, assignment, or subject — 成績；評分

The presentation contributed significantly to the students' overall course result.

****中文翻譯：****

我和組員正在圖書館準備一個很重要的簡報，而那個簡報佔了我們****成績****很大一部分。

So here:

****grade = 學業評核中得到的成績或分數結果****

1. ****grade (成績；評分結果) — 成績；分數等級****

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> The presentation counted for a large part of our ****grade****.

那個簡報佔了我們****總成績****很大一部分。

Practice 2

> She got a high ****grade**** in history.

她歷史科取得很高的****成績****。

Practice 3

> My final ****grade**** improved after the last assignment.

最後一次功課後，我的****最終成績****提高了。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****grade = 學校、課程或作業中用來表示學生表現水平的成績****

2. ****final grade — 最終成績****

Practice 1

> The exam counts for 50% of the ****final grade****.

考試佔**最終成績**的 50%。

Practice 2

> Your **final grade** will include coursework and participation.

你的**最終成績**會包括平時作業和課堂參與。

MCQ-ready definition:

final grade = 完成整個課程或科目後所得的最後總成績

3. **get / receive a grade — 得到成績**

Practice 1

> I **got a good grade** on the presentation.

我的簡報取得了**好成績**。

Practice 2

> Students will **receive their grades** next week.

學生下星期會**收到成績**。

MCQ-ready definition:

get/receive a grade = 在作業、考試或課程中得到評分結果

4. **grade point / GPA — 績點 / 平均績點**

A major academic sense.

Practice 1

> Her **grade point average** is very high.

她的**平均績點**很高。

Practice 2

> Some universities consider your **GPA** when reviewing applications.

有些大學審核申請時會考慮你的**平均績點**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****grade point / GPA = 把成績轉換為數字後計算出的平均學業表現指標****

5. ****grade (年級) — 年級****

A major separate noun sense, especially AmE.

Practice 1

> She is in the fifth ****grade****.

她讀****五年級****。

Practice 2

> What ****grade**** are you in?

你讀****幾年級****？

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****grade = 學校教育中的一個年級階段，尤其常見於美式英語****

6. ****first grade / sixth grade — 一年級 / 六年級****

Practice 1

> He started ****first grade**** this year.

他今年開始讀****一年級****。

Practice 2

> She teaches ****sixth-grade students****.

她教****六年級學生****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****X grade = 美國等教育制度中的第 X 個年級****

7. **grade level — 年級程度；學習級別**

Practice 1

> The book is suitable for this **grade level**.

這本書適合這個**年級程度**。

Practice 2

> His reading ability is above **grade level**.

他的閱讀能力高於**同年級水平**。

MCQ-ready definition:

grade level = 某個學校年級通常應有的學習或能力水平

8. **grade (等級；級別) — 等級；級別**

A broad classification sense.

Practice 1

> This is a high **grade** of steel.

這是一種高**級別**的鋼材。

Practice 2

> The products are divided into different **grades**.

產品被分成不同**等級**。

MCQ-ready definition:

grade = 根據質素、大小、能力或標準劃分的一個級別

9. **high-grade / low-grade — 高級 / 低級；高品質 / 低品質**

Practice 1

> The factory uses **high-grade materials**.

工廠使用**高品質材料**。

Practice 2

> The fuel was too **low-grade** for the engine.

那種燃料對這台引擎來說**品質太低**。

MCQ-ready definition:

high-/low-grade = 處於較高 / 較低質素或標準等級的

10. **grade A — A 級；最高級別之一**

Practice 1

> These eggs are **Grade A**.

這些雞蛋屬於**A 級**。

Practice 2

> The product meets **Grade A standards**.

這個產品符合**A 級標準**。

MCQ-ready definition:

Grade A = 某些分級制度中的高等級或優質級別

11. **food grade — 食品級**

Practice 1

> The container is made from **food-grade plastic**.

這個容器以**食品級塑膠**製成。

Practice 2

> Use only **food-grade materials**.

只使用**食品級材料**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****food-grade = 符合與食品接觸或食品用途安全標準的****

12. ****medical grade — 醫療級****

Practice 1

> The product uses ****medical-grade silicone****.

這個產品使用****醫療級矽膠****。

Practice 2

> The device must meet ****medical-grade standards****.

這個裝置必須符合****醫療級標準****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****medical-grade = 符合醫療用途所需品質或安全標準的****

13. ****industrial grade — 工業級****

Practice 1

> The machine uses ****industrial-grade components****.

這部機器使用****工業級零件****。

Practice 2

> This cleaner is ****industrial grade****.

這款清潔劑屬於****工業級****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****industrial-grade = 按工業用途的要求和標準製造的****

14. ****grade (verb : 評分) — 評分 ; 批改****

A major verb sense.

Practice 1

> The teacher **graded our presentations**.

老師為我們的簡報**評分**。

Practice 2

> She spent the evening **grading papers**.

她整個晚上都在**批改作業 / 評分**。

MCQ-ready definition:

grade work = 根據標準評估學生作業或表現並給予分數或等級

15. **grade an exam / paper — 批改試卷 / 作業**

Practice 1

> It took two days to **grade the exams**.

批改這些試卷花了兩天。

Practice 2

> The professor **graded the essays** carefully.

教授仔細地**批改作文**。

MCQ-ready definition:

grade an exam/paper = 檢查答案或作品並給予成績

16. **grading system — 評分制度 ; 分級制度**

Practice 1

> The school uses a letter **grading system**.

學校使用字母**評分制度**。

Practice 2

> Different countries use different **grading systems**.

不同國家使用不同的**成績評級制度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

grading system = 用來把表現、質素或能力分配到不同成績 / 級別的**制度**

17. **grade** (verb : 分級 ; 分類) — 按級別分類

Practice 1

> The fruit is **graded by size and quality**.

水果按大小和品質**分級**。

Practice 2

> The diamonds are **graded according to quality**.

鑽石按品質**分級**。

MCQ-ready definition:

grade something = 根據質素、大小或其他標準把物品劃分為不同等級

18. **graded** (分級的 ; 按難度排列的) — 分級的

Practice 1

> The course uses **graded reading materials**.

這個課程使用**分級閱讀材料**。

Practice 2

> The exercises become harder in **graded steps**.

練習按**分級方式**逐漸變難。

MCQ-ready definition:

graded = 被安排成不同程度、級別或難度的

19. **graded reader** — 分級讀物

Practice 1

> Beginners often learn through **graded readers**.

初學者常透過**分級讀物**學習。

Practice 2

> This **graded reader** uses simplified vocabulary.

這本**分級讀物**使用較簡化的詞彙。

MCQ-ready definition:

graded reader = 按學習者語言程度控制詞彙和難度的讀物

20. **grade** (坡度 ; 斜度) — 坡度

A major engineering/road sense, especially AmE.

Practice 1

> The road has a steep **grade**.

這條路的**坡度很斜**。

Practice 2

> The train struggled on the steep **grade**.

火車在陡峭的**坡段**上行駛得很吃力。

MCQ-ready definition:

grade = the degree of slope of a road, railway, or surface

中文：

道路、鐵路或表面的傾斜程度

21. **steep grade** — 陡坡；大坡度

Practice 1

> Trucks slow down on the **steep grade**.

貨車在**陡坡**上會減速。

Practice 2

> Cyclists found the **grade** difficult.

單車手覺得那段**坡度**很難應付。

MCQ-ready definition:

steep grade = 傾斜程度很大的道路或地面

22. **grade** (verb : 整平地面；調整坡度) — 整平；按坡度修整

An engineering/construction sense.

Practice 1

> Workers **graded** the land before construction.

工人在施工前先把土地**整平 / 調整坡度**。

Practice 2

> The road was **graded** to improve drainage.

道路經過**整坡處理**以改善排水。

MCQ-ready definition:

grade land/road = 把地面修整成適當平整度或坡度

23. **grader** (評分者) — 評卷者；評分者

Practice 1

> Each essay is checked by two **graders**.

每篇作文由兩名**評分者**批改。

Practice 2

> The **grader** gave detailed feedback.

評卷者提供了詳細評語。

MCQ-ready definition:

grader = 負責評分或分級的人

24. **grader (某年級學生) —年級學生**

Especially AmE in compounds.

Practice 1

> She's a fourth **grader**.

她是**四年級學生**。

Practice 2

> The programme is designed for eighth **graders**.

這個計劃是為**八年級學生**設計的。

MCQ-ready definition:

X-grader = 美國英語中就讀 X 年級的學生

25. **grader (平地機) — 平地機**

A machinery sense.

Practice 1

> A road **grader** levelled the surface.

一部道路**平地機**把路面整平。

Practice 2

> The construction crew used a **grader**.

施工隊使用了一部**平地機**。

MCQ-ready definition:

grader = 用來整平道路或土地表面的重型機械

26. **gradation — 漸變；層次變化**

A related form with a distinct semantic branch.

Practice 1

> The painting shows a smooth **gradation of colour**.

這幅畫呈現出平滑的**色彩漸變**。

Practice 2

> There are many subtle **gradations** between the two extremes.

兩個極端之間有很多細微的**層次變化**。

MCQ-ready definition:

gradation = 一系列逐步而細微的程度、色彩或狀態變化

27. **gradual — 逐漸的；漸進的**

Practice 1

> There was a **gradual improvement** in his performance.

他的表現出現了**逐漸改善**。

Practice 2

> The change was slow and **gradual**.

這個變化緩慢而**漸進**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****gradual = happening slowly in small stages rather than suddenly****

28. ****gradually — 逐漸地****

Practice 1

> The situation ****gradually**** improved.

情況****逐漸****改善。

Practice 2

> The sky ****gradually**** became darker.

天空****慢慢****變暗。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****gradually = slowly, in small stages over time****

Important distinction 1: ****grade vs mark****

Very important in education.

****grade****

often an overall result or category:

* A

* B

* 85%

* course grade

****mark****

often a numerical score for a particular piece of work, especially BrE.

> exam mark = 考試分數

> final grade = 最終成績

They overlap substantially depending on education system.

Important distinction 2: **grade vs score**

grade

academic evaluation.

score

points achieved in:

- * tests

- * games

- * competitions

> a grade of A

A 級成績

> a score of 90

90 分

Important distinction 3: **grade vs result**

grade

specific assessment level/score.

result

broader outcome.

> exam grade

考試成績

> exam result

考試結果

Result can include pass/fail or overall outcome beyond the exact grade.

Important distinction 4: **grade = 成績 vs grade = 年級**

Academic result

> I got a good grade.

我取得好成績。

School year

> I'm in Grade 10.

我讀十年級。

Same noun, completely different reference.

Important distinction 5: **grade vs class/year in school**

In AmE:

> Grade 6

六年級

In BrE systems, learners more often encounter:

> Year 6

六年級 / 學年名稱

Your earlier passages used **Form One to Form Six**, which is another education-system naming convention.

Important distinction 6: **grade = level vs quality**

Level

> Grade 5 piano

五級鋼琴

Quality

> high-grade steel

高級鋼材

Both are classification uses, but the criterion differs.

Important distinction 7: **grade vs rank**

grade

category/level based on standards.

rank

position relative to others or organizational status.

> pay grade

薪級

> military rank

軍階

They can overlap institutionally but are not synonyms.

Important distinction 8: **grade as verb vs mark as verb**

grade

especially AmE:

> grade papers

批改作業

mark

especially BrE:

> mark papers

批改作業

Both are standard.

Important distinction 9: **grade vs classify**

grade

classify according to quality or level.

classify

broader: organize into categories of any kind.

> grade fruit by size

按大小把水果分級

> classify animals by species

按物種分類動物

Important distinction 10: **graded reader vs ordinary reader**

graded reader

difficulty deliberately controlled for learners.

reader

could simply mean a person who reads or a reading book.

So **graded** here means “按程度分級”, not “already marked by a teacher.”

Important distinction 11: **grade = slope vs level**

grade

how steep a surface is.

****level****

how flat or horizontal something is.

A steep grade is specifically ****not**** level.

Important distinction 12: ****high grade vs high mark****

****high grade****

can mean:

- * strong academic result

- * high-quality material

****high mark****

normally academic/test score or figurative approval.

Context matters.

Important distinction 13: ****food-grade does not mean tasty or high-quality food****

It means:

****suitable/safe for food-related use****

A food-grade container may be very ordinary in quality but still meet food safety standards.

Important distinction 14: ****grade A may depend on the grading system****

****Grade A**** generally suggests high quality, but exact standards vary by domain.

So learners should not assume “A” always means identical criteria across:

- * food,

- * products,

- * school,

* industrial classification.

Important distinction 15: **gradual** is related in form but semantically shifted

grade

level/category

gradation

step-by-step change between levels

gradual

changing in small steps over time

So the semantic link is:

> **levels → stages → gradual change**

Family-extension note

Grade has several strong modern branches:

1. **academic result**

* grade

* final grade

* GPA

2. **school year**

* fifth grade

* grade level

* fifth grader

3. **quality/classification level**

* high-grade

* Grade A

* food-grade

* industrial-grade

4. **verb: assess**

- * grade exams
- * grading system

5. **verb: classify**

- * grade fruit
- * grade materials

6. **slope**

- * steep grade
- * road grade

7. **construction**

- * grade land

8. **family extension of stages**

- * gradation
- * gradual
- * gradually

For your passage, the relevant meaning is:

grade = overall academic result

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
grade (academic)	成績	academic result
final grade	最終成績	overall result
get a grade	取得成績	receive evaluation
grade point	績點	numerical academic value
GPA	平均績點	average performance
grade (school year)	年級	education stage
Grade 5	五年級	school level
grade level	年級程度	expected level
grade (classification)	等級；級別	quality/category
high-grade	高級 / 高品質的	high level

low-grade	低級 / 低品質的	low level	
Grade A	A 級	classification	
food-grade	食品級	food-safe standard	
medical-grade	醫療級	medical standard	
industrial-grade	工業級	industrial standard	
grade (verb)	評分；批改	assess work	
grade an exam	批改試卷	score work	
grading system	評分制度	assessment structure	
grade by quality	按品質分級	classify	
graded reader	分級讀物	controlled difficulty	
grade (slope)	坡度	inclination	
steep grade	陡坡	strong slope	
grade land	整平 / 整坡	construction	
grader (person)	評分者	evaluator	
grader (student)	某年級學生	AmE school level	
grader (machine)	平地機	construction machine	
gradation	漸變；層次	stages	
gradual	逐漸的	step-by-step	
gradually	逐漸地	slowly over time	

For your original sentence

> My group and I were in the library preparing for an important presentation that counted for a large part of our **grade**.

Here:

grade = 這門課 / 這項學業評核的總成績

So:

> **counted for a large part of our grade**

> = **佔我們總成績很大一部分**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我和組員正在圖書館準備一個很重要的簡報，而那個簡報**佔了我們總成績很大一部分**。

The key learner trap is that **grade** here is **成績**, not **年級** or **等級**.